

Regular Meeting
May 21, 2018
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:03 p.m. Those present were Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau that the minutes of May 7, 2018 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau seconded by Ms. Mustone that the tabled minutes of April 9, 2018 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Kreatz that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Mr. Ruggiero asked about the payment to Minuteman Regional and would like a breakdown of enrollments and programs students are attending.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to take papers out of order to hear community participation :

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Anthony Petrelis and Chris Murphy were given permission to speak. Anthomy Petrelis informed everyone that this year Team Heemo is hosting their first ever Medford Community Buzz-Off at John Brewers Tavern Saturday June 2nd from 6-11pm. We have been buzzing our heads for the last 5 years at Gillette Stadium for One Mission a charity that raises money for children currently going through cancer treatment and their families. We do it in honor of ALL children battling Cancer, but in particular a Medford boy named Heemo Abdulfaraj, who passed away 5 years ago of a rare form of Cancer. He was a third grade student at the McGlynn Elementary. We have grown from a 5 person team, to now being over 60 people who buzz, fundraise, and help put our events together. Last year we had people from the City of Medford get very involved in particular City Hall and the Police Department. They met with us and helped us promote our Team and the event. We got donations from the Kiwanis Club, Medford City Council, and Medford School Committee. The Medford Police Department gave us a personal escort all the way down to Gillette Stadium last year. We are so lucky and blessed to have such a great community come together and support such an amazing cause. The Students at the Medford Voc Tech created our t shirts and the High School video department made a great video for us to put all over social media.

Discussion:

Members thanked Mr. Petrelis and Mr. Murphy for their dedication to this endeavor and wished them the best for this year's event.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Three Medford High School freshman students presented their CSSR project idea on implementing a fruit orchard beginning in the Fall of 2018. They propose planting an orchard with fruit trees and various bushes on the plot of land by the community schools entrance.

Discussion:

Members were excited and supportive of the project. Member Ruggiero offered his assistance to the students.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to approve the orchard project:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Student Award

Director of Foreign Language Rita DiCarlo presented the report. She stated that she is pleased to announce that one of our students Qing Cheng has won a prestigious award. Qing was the only student in Massachusetts to score in the top one percent in her level on the National Italian Exam this year and win a gold medal. She not only received a gold medal and a check for \$50.00, but also is one of seven students in the entire country to be awarded a scholarship consisting of a 2-week course at a language school in Italy that includes accommodations and tuition. This award is through a collaboration of AATI (American Association of Teachers of Italian) and some language schools in Italy. Additionally Qing received a cash award of 1,000 for travel expenses. These scholarships went to the top students and we are very proud that one of our Italian III Honors students, Qing Cheng attained this prestigious award.

Quing was congratulated and presented a school committee award.

On the motion Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero to revert back to the regular order of business.

Superintendent Belson said that the minutes of the Committee of the Whole – May 17, 2018 were not complete and would be available at the next meeting.

Report on Building Bridges to Kindergarten

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. Ms. Caldwell reported that the program took place on April 10th and was repeated on May 3rd. Maria Micieli a kindergarten teacher at the Brooks School presented to the families what to expect as their child enters kindergarten. There was discussion and questions about curriculum, snacks and lunch, safety protocols, before and after school care and riding the bus. Before and after school registration is in progress at this time.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruggiero asked what the cost would be to offer all day preK to children. Ms. Caldwell answered that she would have to research and get back to him. Mr. Ruggiero asked for a report back on how much a preK program would cost. Ms. DiBenedetto asked how many new enrollees we have in the before and after school programs. Ms. Caldwell said that most kindergarten parents want it so they are trying to increase the Columbus. The Brooks is very full. Staffing is the biggest issue. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if all students will get a spot. Ms. Caldwell answered that she can't guarantee that right now. There are a few on the wait list at the Brooks but once staff is in place they will have a better idea.

Report on Columbus After School Math Tutoring Program

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report along with Principal Kathleen Kay. The program began on January 30 and ended on May 3rd. Grade 3 had 21 students attend, grade 4 had 29 and grade 5 had 18 students. Six teachers along with Principal Kay and Assistant Principal Sherman-Hudson worked with the students. They also had the help of six National Honor Students who volunteered to work with the children. Principal Kay mentioned a few things that she would adjust for the next session: break up into two sessions with smaller groups; a more comprehensive job description for the teachers; and a consistent team of educators.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked if there was any way to tell if the students showed growth. Ms. Kay answered that the students were given pre and post tests; some did better; some stayed the same. She also stated that there were a large number of absences so that will have to be stressed for a next session. Ms. DiBenedetto asked about the cost involved. She would like a breakdown of the cost of the program. She suggested that maybe having math coaches would be a more affordable option. Ms. DiBenedetto requested a report to show the growth of students from 5th grade to 6th grade in October. Mr. Ruggiero said that he is a huge fan of the after school tutoring and asked if we added teachers it would help. Ms. Caldwell answered that it was hard to get teachers. Mr. Ruggiero asked what percent of students used the bus. Ms. Kay said one third. Ms. Van der Koot said she would like to see smaller more targeted groups. She would also like to see a shorter time period. She asked if they would try to have a session in the Fall. Ms. Kay answered perhaps in November after the MCAS scores are received. Ms. Kreatz also likes the idea of smaller groups.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruggiero to track students in the fall on grade 5 MCAS and to receive a report on breakdown of costs of program:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Seal of Biliteracy

Director of Foreign Language Rita DiCarlo presented the report. Ms. DiCarlo reported that this is an award given by school districts to students who have attained a high level of proficiency in English and at least one other language by the time they graduate from high school. The Biliteracy Seal Award becomes part of the high school transcript and diploma for these students. The Seal certifies attainment of biliteracy for students, employers, and universities, evidencing the student's career and college readiness, as well as the student's global engagement. In 2015 the bill was filed in the Massachusetts legislature along with the LOOK (Language Opportunity for Our Kids) Bill and it was finally signed by Governor Baker on November 22, 2017. On March 27, 2018 proposed amendments to Massachusetts Certificate of Mastery Regulations, 603 CMR 31.00 was presented to the Board of Elementary and Secondary Education for initial review and vote to solicit public comment. The period for public comment is through May 18, 2018 and final action by DESE is anticipated for June 26, 2018. The Massachusetts State Seal of Biliteracy should be ready for September 2018. All students are eligible for the Seal of Biliteracy based on evidence of achieving the designated level of language proficiency in

English and at least one more language. To demonstrate proficiency in English MCAS scores will be used or ACCESS scores for EL's. To demonstrate proficiency in another language, there are a few approved national exams such as the AP exam, Standards-based Measurement of Proficiency (STAMP) test, ACTFL Assessment of Performance toward Proficiency in Language (AAPPL) test, ACTFL Latin Interpretive Reading Exam (ALIRA) for Latin and other assessments correlated to the required minimum level of language proficiency. By awarding the Massachusetts State Seal of Biliteracy to Medford High School seniors we provide evidence to universities and businesses that our students have attained these important 21st century skills. We would like to award the Seal to qualifying graduating seniors in June of next year (2019) and we are asking for your support in this. This year we are doing a pilot and are hoping to award a certificate to qualifying students.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot loves the idea. She asked the cost and how many students are involved. Ms. DiCarlo said that it is \$20 and this year there are 20 students but next year there is the possibility of 60-75. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if she is asking students to pay for this. Ms. DiCarlo said that next year there will be a line in the budget. Ms. Mustone asked what languages are taught. Ms. DiCarlo answered French, Italian and Spanish.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Pre Budget Report – Foreign Language

Ms. DiCarlo presented the report. She stated that

Overview of Department

- Program at each grade span
 - Students are introduced to Italian in 2nd grade which continues to 5th grade
 - Choice of Spanish or Italian in middle school
 - High School offers from 1st level to AP courses in French, Italian, and Spanish
- Number of teachers
 - Four foreign language teachers at the middle school (two at each middle school)
 - One teacher traveling between the two middle schools
 - Ten foreign language teachers at the High School

Use of Funding SY 17-18

- All funds were used as allocated in the budget
- Highlights and Accomplishments SY 17-18
- Trips: New York City; Spain; Montreal and Quebec City
- Contests and Awards :

- AP Italian student wins \$1,000 scholarship from the FAA-USA
- French student earned second place and won \$200 at the French Oratory Contest
- Italian students won second prize in a contest at Northeastern University
- A fourth grade class at the Roberts and four Italian students at the high school won at the C.A.S.IT. Contest
- Events :
 - Italian students attend a night at the Opera
 - AP Spanish students participated in Spanish classes at Tufts University
 - The Foreign Language Club sponsored “*It Takes Two to Ultimate Tango*”
- Professional Development : MAFLA Conference; Saturday workshops
- Exams Administered : National exams; AP exams; AAPPL exams

Requests for budget SY 18-19 - Level funded

Number of Current Staff and Anticipated Staffing Needs

- 15 full time teachers - No additional staff needed

Goals and Objectives for SY 2018-2019

- Continue to update and fine tune the curriculum
- Implement the Massachusetts Seal of Biliteracy

Discussion:

Mr. Ruggiero asked if students show any interest in other languages. Ms. DiCarlo said that students were given a survey and the results were Spanish, Italian, French and Portuguese in that order. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for a breakdown of the number of students in each language. Ms. DiCarlo said she did not have that with her but will send it to her. Ms. DiBenedetto thanked Ms. DiCarlo for the many opportunities that she has given to her students. Ms. Van der Kloot said that it has been a wonderful journey and thanked Rita for her dedication.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Ms. Kreatz the report was accepted and placed on file and the request for enrollments forthcoming:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to take papers out of order:

Ms. DiCarlo requested approval of a trip to Italy which will coincide with April vacation week 2019. Ms. Chalifoux will serve as trip leader. Travel Design Italy an educational travel agency which we have used in the past and have been very satisfied with their service. This organization uses major airlines and provides professional liability and medical insurance. The approximate cost will be \$3300 per student.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Kreatz to approve the 2019 trip to Italy:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Pre Budget Report – EL

Director of EL Paul Texeira presented the report.

Program Description

- K-12 EL curriculum is aligned to the *WIDA Standards and ELA Common Core*
- Instructional practices are aligned with program materials
- EL instructional staff
 - Elementary 14 Teachers
 - Middle 4 Teachers
 - High School 6 Teachers

Highlights of SY2017-2018

- McGlynn Middle School EL Redesign
- Coordinated program Review
- Pre-K - 12 Professional Development offerings
- Progress Monitoring for struggling English learners
- Grade Level English Language Development Progress Reports
- Fall and Spring Common Writing Prompts
- Partnership with STARBASE STEM Labs at Hanscom Air Force Base for Summer Enrichment
- English Learner Parent Advisory Council (ELPAC)
- Student Translation Community Service program at MHS
- Language Acquisition Teams (LAT) at every building for mid-year and end-of-year placements
- 100% participation for ACCESS testing and decreased testing days in each building
- Streamlined EL testing procedures and parent/guardian notification processes
- Life After High School Program at MHS during April vacation

Use of Funding for SY2017-2018

- EL Intro to Physics Science Textbooks
- Summer testing and registration of ELs
- Instructional materials and office supplies to support the EL program K-12
- District Translations

Funding Requests for SY2018-2019

- Level funding for summer labor, translations, office supplies, instructional supplies
- Increase textbook budget from \$4,000 to \$7,000 due to the McGlynn EL redesign requirements
- Additional McGlynn Middle School EL Teacher to meet the needs of the EL redesign
- Convert the high school long-term sub to a full-time EL teacher

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot asked about the middle school redesign and if it will remain at the McGlynn. Mr. Texeira answered that the design will be structured as two teams. He could put the some at the Andrews but that would require four additional teachers. Mr. Ruseau asked about the New Comers program and why students don't remain at that school. Superintendent Belson answered that it depends on the situation with siblings or parental requests. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if we are seeing an increase in the EL population. Mr. Texeira said that currently we have 499 students. Ms. DiBenedetto said that with such growth we need to plan for more plans for EL. She would like to revisit in September or October with a curriculum subcommittee meeting to discuss the long term plan. She asked Mr. Texeira if we are in compliance. He answered yes.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Mustone to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to move Negotiations and Legal Matters to the end of the calendar.

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Lesley University and Medford Public Schools Partnership Agreement

Superintendent Belson updated the Committee on the development of an RFP to be advertised as soon as possible regarding the formation of a partnership.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau asked if the RFP can include wage specifications. Superintendent Belson said it says prevailing wages are to be paid. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that the number one item is to use an area university. Superintendent Belson said that they would like to have the interaction of an area university. Ms. DiBenedetto asked how far would we consider in miles. Superintendent Belson answered about twenty miles. Ms. DiBenedetto asked about section 4 and why the change regarding the renovation went from us to them and she asked if this is different from any other RFP. Superintendent Belson said that they are generally standard criteria. Mr. Ruggiero asked what the provisions in section 4 are. Superintendent Belson answered that they must meet

NCAA regulations. Ms. Van der Kloot asked what if we get more than one interested school. Superintendent Belson said that they will look at each one and they must meet the criteria.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau to go forward with the RFP:
Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Middle School Selection Decision

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson presented the report. She reported that at our May 7th meeting the results of the middle school selection were presented. The numbers at that time showed that if choice was allowed the Andrews would have 174 students and the McGlynn 118 entering grade 6. At the time of the middle school section parents were informed that if choice resulted in an imbalance there would be a partial lottery. On May 7th the Committee decided that prior to conducting a partial lottery parents who opted for the Andrews would be allowed to have the option of keeping groups of students together if the cohort would transfer their request of school to the McGlynn. Unfortunately only one group of 5 students has transferred their request to the McGlynn. The adjusted numbers show a difference of 47 more students currently requesting the Andrews. Therefore per the Committee's agreement we will need to conduct the partial lottery to allow for 20 additional student movements from the two schools who are not sending a proportional number of students to the McGlynn. We hope to do this as soon as possible as parents are eager to get school assignments and principals can begin to schedule.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruseau asked Ms. Nelson to make sure that the 5 students are on the same team. She answered that they are. Ms. Van der Kloot asked about the team distribution at the Andrews. Ms. Nelson said that numbers can't be guaranteed because of sped students and that exploratory has to be factored in. Ms. Kreatz asked for an explanation of how the partial lottery will be held. Superintendent Belson explained it and said that no sped or EL students are included. Mr. Ruggiero commented that this is very frustrating and that he hoped it would go away. Superintendent Belson said that we have been discussing the issue for about one year but hopefully this is not a permanent occurrence. Mr. Ruggiero suggested that the Brooks send 20 students to the McGlynn. Ms. Nelson said that we must stay within the language of the letter which states a partial lottery. Mr. Ruseau commented that we need to have a conversation at a Committee of the Whole about removing choice. Ms. DiBenedetto said that it is difficult for parents but both are good schools and she hopes to go to total lottery someday. Ms. Jenny Graham, was given permission to speak. She asked if Mr. Tucci has gone to the elementary schools to talk to the students. She said he is a valuable part of the decision but he needs to be out and meeting with students and parents.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot that Mr. Tucci meets with Brooks students and parents. Letters with the information regarding the visits will be sent home with 5th grade students.
Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0

Absent: 0

Shore Collaborative Quarterly Report

Member Ruseau presented the report from Shore which was accepted and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Discussion of Application of Open Meeting Law to Electronic Devices – Member Ruseau
Member Ruseau said that the school committee is not mouthpieces for people sitting at home texting us. People in the audience should be heard. It is important not the have private conversations with the public while we are in session.

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to make a school committee rule not to have private communication within our authority except an emergency:

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 1 DiBenedetto

Absent: 0

Mr. Ruggiero would like to pursue an avenue of communication with persons who can't be in attendance. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that many single parents can't attend and may want something brought up.

Discussion of Pending Legislation on Recess – Member Ruseau

Superintendent Belson reported that

Member Paul Ruseau is asking for the School Committee to consider the provisions of Senate Bill 308 and House Bill 235 which would mandate a fixed amount of time for students in elementary schools.

“All children in grades K-5 shall receive one hundred minutes of supervised, safe of unstructured free-play recess each week...(20 consecutive minutes each day)”

Further that regulations promulgated by the Department may not exclude recess from structured learning time and the Department may not increase the total minutes of having requirement in the school year to meet the provisions of this new legal subsection.

Currently the practice in the Medford Public Schools is as follows:

- Brooks: 20-30 minutes daily, kindergarten may have more as they have a snack recess as well
- Columbus: 20 minutes, kindergarten sometimes has more depending on day, need, weather
- McGlynn: 20-25 minutes daily
- Roberts: Around 20 minutes, Grade 5 does not have recess on Wednesday due to early release

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to support the recess paper:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to go to Executive Session at 10:26 p.m. for an update on contract negotiations, contract negotiations with Superintendent elect and update on pending legal matters. The committee will not be returning to open session.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

The meeting adjourned at 10:34 p.m.

Respectfully submitted:

Kathy Kreatz
Secretary

